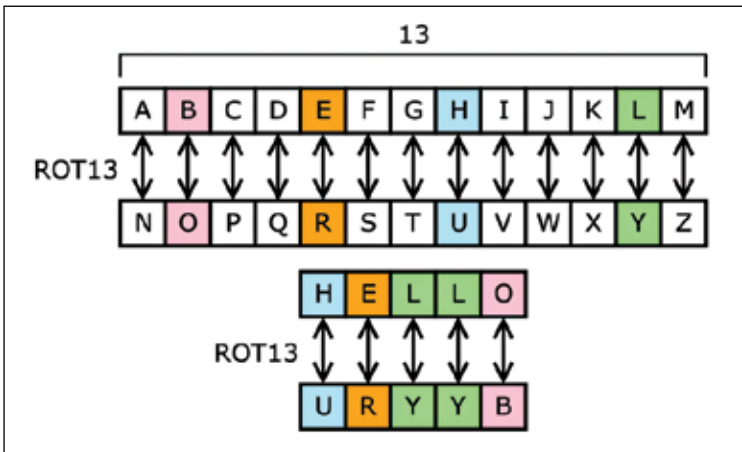




ROT13 mapping

deciphering (well, we should already call it encoding and decoding), the table must be present. A person receiving a message ciphered using the map presented in the table would not be able to decipher it without the complete table available with them. Why do we present it if it's just a code? Well, we do so to show the fine line which separates coding from encryption. We do so because we think it's fascinating to witness how organizing a random shuffle using a simple number turns a code into a ciphering technique; how it starts to involve calculations instead of maps!

What we demonstrated is a simple substitution cipher which involves rotating the alphabets by a number. However this is just one example of how substitution ciphers can work. There are other ways in which substitutions can be done. One of the more complicated ciphers is Vigenère cipher which utilizes a table of substitutions.

This cipher is known as a type of 'polyalphabetic' cipher as a single letter in plaintext can take multiple values in ciphertext. It utilizes the rotation technique we just described. As you can see, the table contains 26 rows each for each character in the alphabet where the position of the alphabet determines the number of rotations done for the row. The way to use this cipher follows:

1. First get the plaintext. Let it be "ILOVEDIGITMAGAZINE".
2. Decide a keyword which will be used to encrypt the plaintext. Let's use 'TRACK' as our keyword.